

CREATE A LINKEDIN PROFILE THAT GETS YOU NOTICED

LinkedIn is a professional online networking platform that can help new technical writers establish a professional online presence, showcase their job skills, and connect with prospective employers.

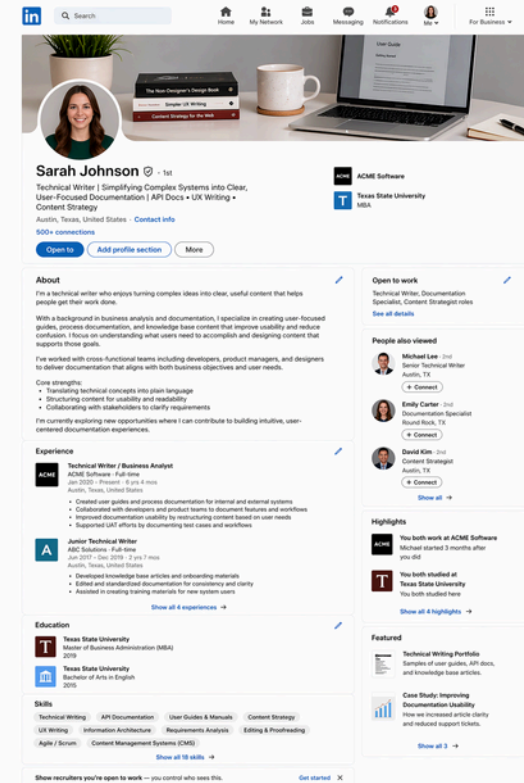
A professional LinkedIn profile is almost as important as an effective resume as part of your job search and can be a valuable self-marketing tool. Even if you aren't currently looking for employment, an up-to-date and effective profile can help you connect to future opportunities.

It's simple to set up a LinkedIn account using the platform's free functionalities without upgrading to a paid pro account. However, a mediocre or incomplete profile may undersell your skills and abilities and hinder your job search. An impactful profile will help recruiters or potential employers form favorable impressions of you and your work. Here are some tips to help you create a standout account.



A practical guide for new technical writers

When creating or updating your LinkedIn profile, you want to clearly showcase your skills, so recruiters recognize your value and reach out.





Career coach Dr. Heather Marietta² states that approximately 48% of recruiters use the skills section of LinkedIn profiles explicitly to fill open positions.

² How Much Experience Is Too Much?: <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/how-much-experience-too-heather-marietta-ed-d--5ck2c>

1

Use a good photo

Upload a current, professional photo of yourself. Use a good quality image, preferably a headshot, that represents you in a positive light.

2

Complete every section of your profile

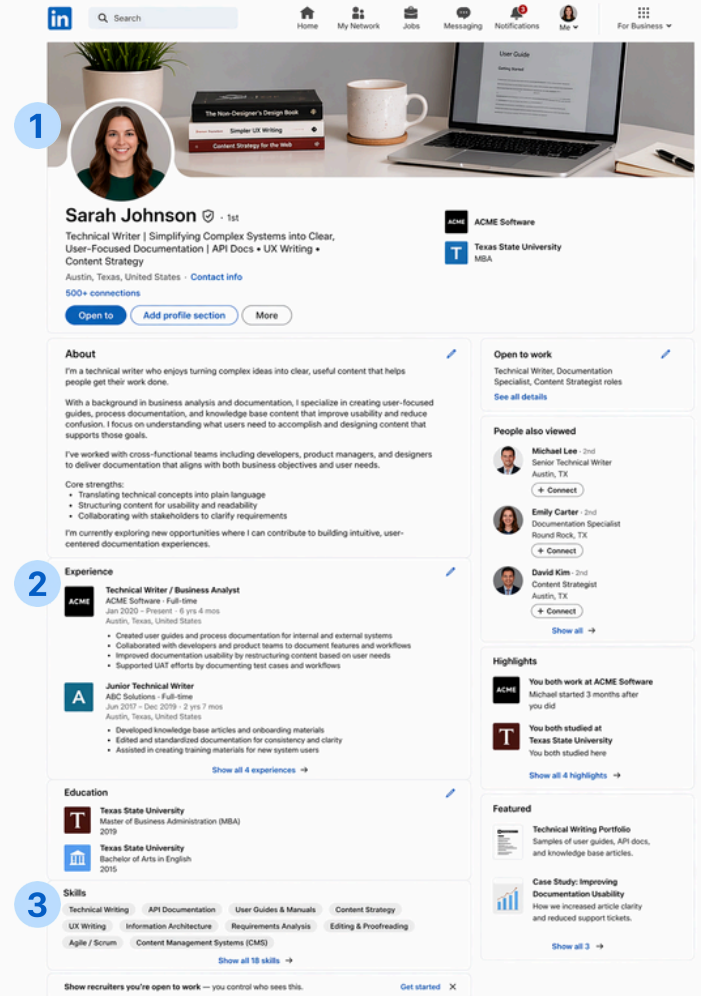
Missing experience, skills, or education can diminish the effectiveness of your profile.

You don't need to extensively list every work position on your profile but focus on your most relevant experience in the past 10 years.

3

Showcase your skills

Pay attention to the "Skills" section of your profile and use this as a tool to showcase your expertise.





A 2025 LinkedIn report² shows that 72% of recruiters use LinkedIn as a tool to hire new employees. Additionally, 87% of recruiters vet job candidates using LinkedIn.

² LinkedIn's Impact on Job Hunting: Facts & Figures (2025):
<https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/linkedin-impact-job-hunting-facts-figures-2025-sagar-hedau-okdwf>

4

Create a personalized headline

A headline is a brief line of text that appears directly below your name on your LinkedIn profile and is often the first thing someone sees when they visit your profile.

While LinkedIn defaults to listing your current work position as your headline, you can personalize this text to capture your professional essence and elevate your professional profile.

5

Develop an impactful “About” statement

Like your headline, the “About” section of your profile is an opportunity to highlight your personal mission statement and experiences. Think of it as your elevator pitch for who you are and why you do what you do. Showcase your personality here and be sure to use first person perspective.

6

Connect with potential employers

To start, turn on the “open to work” feature on your profile to show recruiters or employers that you are willing to explore new job opportunities. You can customize this feature to make it visible only to recruiters on LinkedIn.

Engage with prospective companies or employers by “following” them on LinkedIn and engaging with their content to build rapport. You can also seek out hiring managers or recruiters for a particular company by utilizing the search feature on LinkedIn.

